

SQL Naming Conventions

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General

- Ensure the name is unique and does not exist as a reserved keyword.
- Names must begin with a letter and may not end with an underscore.
- Try to avoid using underscores in names.
- **Only use letters and numbers in names.**
- **Avoid abbreviations and if you have to use them make sure they are commonly understood.**

Tables

Table Naming Structure

<Schema>.<ProjectName> <DatasetName> <AdditionalInfo>

- Written in **PascalCase**
- Table names should be less than 126 characters.
- First word represents the project, if created in Production (prd) or Staging (stg) schemas.
- Use a collective name or, less ideally, a plural form. For example (in order of preference) staff and employees.
- Do not prefix with `tbl_` or any other such descriptive prefix or Hungarian notation.
- **Never give a table the same name as one of its columns and vice versa.**
- Avoid, where possible, concatenating two table names together to create the name of a relationship table. Rather than `CarMechanics` prefer `Services`.

- A name that begins with the number sign (#) denotes a temporary table or procedure.
- A name with double number signs (##) denotes a global temporary object. Microsoft doesn't recommend using the single number sign or double number sign to begin an object name.

Old Naming Convention	New Naming Convention
stg.capital_structure_cf220	Staging.CapitalStructureCF220
prd.tcm_p6135_indirect_ta_and_te_non_trans	Production.TCMP16135IndirectTaAndTeNonTrans

Data Model

- When creating tables that have the purpose to be part of a data model, the structure changes slightly to allow the where the ProjectName now becomes the schema.
- **Dim** and **Fact** will be used as suffixes on tables to define whether the specific table is a dimension or factual table

Table Naming Structure - Data Model

<ProjectName>.<DatasetName><AdditionalInfo>Dim

<ProjectName>.<DatasetName><AdditionalInfo>Fact

Columns

- Written in **PascalCase** (may be revised at a later date)
- Always use the singular name.
- Where possible avoid simply using id as the primary identifier for the table.
- For dates, it's good to describe what the date represents. Names like StartDate and EndDate are pretty descriptive. If you want, you can describe them even more precise, using names like `CallStartDate` and `CallEndDate`. Other examples: `FirstName` / `LastName` / `DurationSeconds` / `DataBytes`.
- The suffix `Key` will be reserved for data modelling

Data Model

- When designing a data model columns with the suffix `Key` will be used to identify Primary and Foreign keys between fact and dimension tables
- examples `PipelineKey` / `CountryKey` / `CustomerKey`

Views

View Naming Structure

<SchemaName>.<ProjectName><DatasetName><AdditionalInfo>

- Written in **PascalCase**
- Shares the same rules as [Tables](#)

Data Model

View Naming Structure - Data Model

<ProjectName>.<DatasetName> <AdditionalInfo>

Stored procedures

Stored Procedure Naming Structure

<SchemaName>.<ProjectName> <Verb> <DatasetName> <AdditionalInfo>

- Written in **PascalCase**
- Do not prefix with `sp_` or any other such descriptive prefix or Hungarian notation. (`sp_` being used by system procedures).
- The name must contain a verb. (Avoid using the word Create or Creating)
- Shares the same rules as [Tables](#)

Data Model

Stored Procedure Naming Structure - Data Model

<ProjectName>.<Verb> <DatasetName> <AdditionalInfo>

Schemas

- Written in **PascalCase**
- Only use alphanumeric characters, no underscore.
- Short concise term (no more than 30 characters).

Core

Old Naming Convention	New Naming Convention	Description
stg	Staging	For loading test data and minor transformation
prd	Production	For loading test data and minor transformation
metadata	MetaData	Custom reference information that is created by the team
logging	Logging	Information that is related to logging
	Config	Information that is related to configuring a tool / application by passing in parameters

Data model

Old Naming Convention	New Naming Convention	Description
	Reporting	The core data model that contains the information about the E2E processes. (Does not contain sensitive information... Sensitive information will be stored in it's own seperate schema)
	PowerBI	Information that will be specifically for PowerBI use
	DataMart	Information in its denormalized form for PowerBI, Data Extracts, Data Ingestion... etc

Azure

Ressources

 Ressource naming on Azure sources :

[sqlstyle](#)

[tutorialsteacher.com](#)

[Microsoft \(Azure\)](#).

[brainstation.io](#)

[sqlshack.com](#)

[sqlserver-kit \(GitHub\)](#).